

STUDY ABROAD GUIDE TO DESIGN & GRAPHIC DESIGN



Guide to Graphic Design Abroad



DESIGN IN ENGLISH

The biggest barrier in studying Graphic Design abroad is finding an accredited university that offers the course in an accessible language - English.

We have done the research for you to find universities offering Graphic Design in English.



WARNING!

Each university may require a **portfolio**; prepare it in advance and focus on it!

LISAA (France)

Portfolio

IED (Italy; Spain)

Portfolio; Interview

University of the Arts London (UK)

Portfolio

Politecnico di Milano (Milan)

Admission test

Marbella School of Design (Spain)

Motivation Letter

Design Academy Eindhoven (Netherlands)

Portfolio & home assignments

The New School (USA)

Portfolio

Central Academy of Fine Arts - CAFA (China)

High school diploma

Best Art / Design Schools in Europe:

- Royal College of Art (RCA)
- University of the Arts London
- Politecnico di Milano
- Aalto University
- Design Academy Eindhoven

RCA offers an online program for students to create a personalized portfolio in Adobe InDesign, suitable for higher education applications or professional presentations.



THINGS TO CONSIDER

These are the things you should keep in mind when choosing to study Design abroad.

1

Is the whole degree in English? In all the options we mentioned earlier, you have the chance to study entirely in English. However, in places like China, Germany, Belgium, and the Netherlands, we suggest you check directly with the institution or the official program website.

2

Is the degree widely recognised? Yes, graphic design is globally recognized as a degree for its practical applications across industries and its crucial role in visual communication.

3

What about the finances? Design or graphic design may be pricy programs, yet the professional prospects are promising as design is essential for business success. That's why nowadays it's an acclaimed degree.



OUR TOP PICKS - COUNTRY EDITION

As much as there is variety of options, our three top picks encompass globally recognised universities with full English-taught degrees and high level of satisfaction.

1

Italy

Italy is known for its excellence in art and design education. Many institutions have strong ties to the industry and offer practical, hands-on training along with theoretical knowledge. While there are some programs taught entirely in English, many graphic design programs in Italy are conducted in Italian. Nonetheless, you'd be glad to know that many renowned institutions in the world of design, such as IED, have English-only courses.

2

France

Studying graphic design in France can be an enriching experience, given the country's rich cultural heritage and vibrant arts scene. You can find a variety of graphic design programs ranging from undergraduate to postgraduate levels. These programs often cover a wide range of topics including typography, branding, illustration, web design, and more.

3

UK

The UK boasts a diverse range of institutions offering graphic design programs, including universities, art colleges, and specialized design schools. Each institution may have its own strengths and focuses within the field of graphic design. Your fee status (UK/EU or international) may affect the tuition fees you are required to pay.

OUR TOP PICKS - GRAPHIC DESIGN PROGRAMMES EDITION

Here are our favorite architecture programmes!

Please note that this reflects only our opinion. It should not replace the need for research based on your own preferences.



1

Graphic Design - LISAA

This bachelor's degree in graphic design is a visual communication program. The challenge is to combine a creative sense with commercial and marketing techniques, to create images that convey a message, that have an advertising or militant objective, etc. LISAA is a graphic design school recognized by the Ministry of Culture (one of the few!).

2

Graphic Design - Istituto Europeo di Design (IED)

The program focuses on experimentation and developing your own style, refined in online and offline projects during the 4-year course. The program syllabus encourages interdisciplinary interaction with other areas of Visual Communication, Design, Design Strategies, Fashion and Management in collaborative workshops and joint projects.

3

Graphic Design - University of the Arts London

You'll be taught by designers, photographers, artists, and academics, who are complemented by a wide range of industry professionals who visit the course to lecture and teach. This gives you the opportunity to build your own network of creative practitioners. It is divided into 3 stages over 3 academic years. Each stage consists of 30 teaching weeks.

For more detailed information, check out our University Reports!

OUR TOP PICKS - RELATED PROGRAMMES EDITION

Here are some specific program recommendations related to the field of architecture with very interesting approaches. **Please note** that this reflects only our opinion. It should not replace the need for research based on your own preferences.



1

Architectural Design - Politecnico di Milano

The educational programme includes a wide disciplinary framework based on science, the humanities and arts, reflecting the wide spectrum of knowledge and skills required nowadays by an architect in order to adequately address the challenges, engaging him at an international level.

2

Interior Design - Florence Design Academy

FDA is one of Italy's most renowned design school and one of the world wide best ranked places to study interior design and graphic design. The program is ran by active professionals such as architects and designers who offer practical and theoretical knowledge of interior design and furniture design as well as share their experiences of real world projects.

3

Master in Social Design - Design Academy Eindhoven

In the Masters, design is understand as a medium at the intersection of ethics, politics, and ecology, serving society's deepest aspirations. Social Design emphasises the designers' responsibility in the reorganisations of society. Designers can set conditions for opposing, maintaining, disrupting, or legitimising existing structures. Design is often part of the problems that it claims it can solve.

For more detailed information, check out our University Reports!



NO.1 TIP

Highlight your artistic strengths, such as proficiency in design software like Adobe Creative Suite, drawing, and illustration. These skills demonstrate your ability to craft visually compelling designs that captivate audiences. Let your portfolio showcase these talents, showcasing your versatility and creativity as a graphic designer.

PORTFOLIO ADVICE

Useful tips on creating a portfolio that stands out!

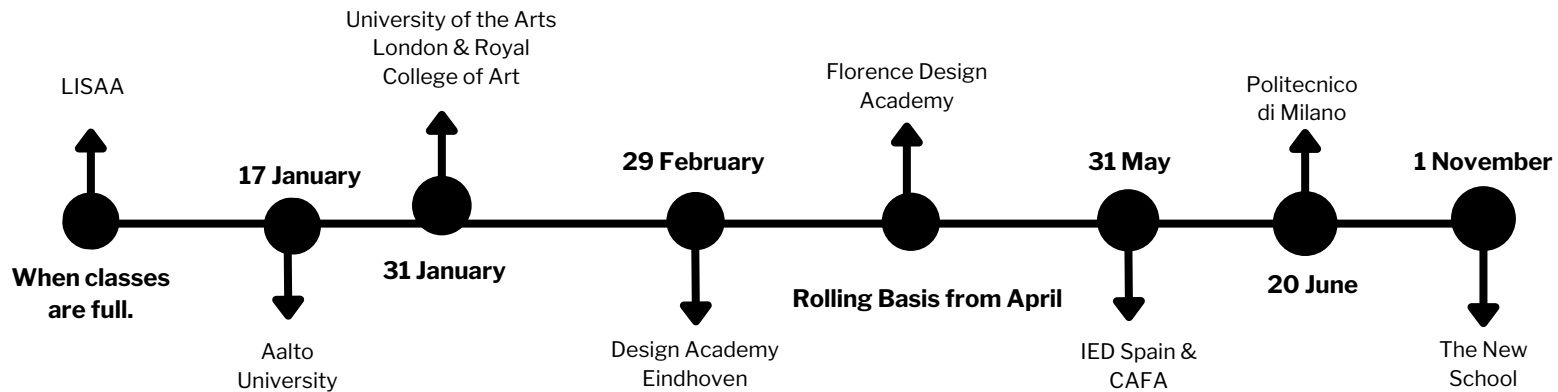
- Be thoughtful about what you include
- 3C rule: curated, clear, concise
- Select your strongest pieces
- Showcase your most unique and creative work
- If you work is varied, include a representative project from each category

PORTFOLIO EXTRA TIPS

1. Show how you have taken creative risks to push boundaries and explore possibilities.
2. Aim to curate 10-15 pages or slides. Do not put too much on each page (1-3 images per page is a good rule of thumb).
3. Tell a story with your work. Create a portfolio that includes work appropriate to the subject you are applying for.

DEADLINE TIMELINE

We have mapped out some of the most important deadlines to keep in mind for many of the universities mentioned in this Guide. **Please note** these dates are **indicative only** and **more steps may be required** to complete the application procedure.



Graphic Design & related programs EU students

University	Course name	Academic requirements	Fee	Deadline
Marbella Design Academy SPAIN	Graphic Design & Media Interior Architecture & Design	IB Diploma Eligibility and entry requirements are aligned with standards set by our UK partner university.	Yearly tuition fee of 12,000 € and administration fee of 2,000 €	The deadline for all September students is the 1st of August, and the 1st of November for the January students.
LISAA Paris FRANCE	Graphic Design Interior Design and Architecture	Portfolio & Oral In	8 790€ (1st year) 9 690€ (2nd and 3rd)	June 30th
IED ITALY	Graphic Design Interior Design	Portfolio Admission test	7,000-12,000 €	Spaces filled on a rolling basis - Apply before April.
ESDI Escola Superior de Disseny SPAIN	Bachelor in Design	Admission test	9,670 €	Rolling basis. It is suggested that the application is submitted 12 to 6 months in advance to the beginning of the academic year in September.
IE University SPAIN	Bachelor in Design	Admission test	25,000 €	Rolling basis.
LCI Barcelona SPAIN	Graphic Design Interior Design	High school diploma	10,500 €	Rolling Basis
Florence Design Academy ITALY	Graphic Design Interior Design	Portfolio and Interview	6,950 € + 500 € Enrollment fee	Rolling Basis from
Accademia Italiana ITALY	Graphic Design Interior and Product Design	Admission test and portfolio	9.600€	Around July (45 days before the start of the course in September)
Royal Academy of Art The Hague NETHERLANDS	Graphic Design Interior Architecture & Furniture Design	Portfolio, interview and/or entry examination day	€2.530	May 1st
Alto University FINLAND				

University	Course name	Academic requirements	Fee	Deadline
University of the Arts London UNITED KINGDOM	Graphic Communication Design	Personal Statement; Portfolio	€ 9250	January 31st
Universidad Europea SPAIN	Design	Motivational Letter, Admission Interview and Language Exams	€ 11,330	Rolling basis
Design Academy Eindhoven NETHERLANDS	Design Studies	Portfolio, Home Assignment & Interview	€2,530.	February 28th
Universitat Politècnica de València (UPV) SPAIN	Interior Architectural Design	Admission test	Credit 17,34 €	From 1st April until 15th May
Universitat Politècnica de València (UPV) SPAIN	Technical Architecture	Admission test	Credit 17,34 €	From 1st April until 15th May
Politecnico di Milano ITALY	Architectural Design	Admission test	Depend on family income Annual all-inclusive contribution is 3,726 €. Only paid by a limited number of students	29th February
The New School USA	Interior Design Graphic Design	Motivational Letter; Creative Assignment; CV	\$28,989	July 31st
Central Academy of Fine Arts CHINA	Visual Communication Design Artistic Design	Portfolio; Health Check	6651 €	Late April